Ch 4.3 - Logistic Regression

Lecture 10 - CMSE 381

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Wed, Sep 17, 2025

Announcements

CMSE381_F2025_Schedule : Schedule

Lec #	Date		Topic	Reading	HW
1	M	8/25	Intro / Python Review	1	
2	W	8/27	What is statistical learning	2.1	
3	F	8.29	Assessing Model Accuracy	2.2.1, 2.2.2	
	M	9/1	Labor Day - No Class		
4	W	9/3	Linear Regression	3.1	
5	F	9/5	More Linear Regression	3.1	HW #1 Due Sun 9/7
6	M	9/8	Multi-linear Regression	3.2	
7	W	9/10	Probably More Linear Regression	3.3	
8	F	9/12	Last of the Linear Regression		HW #2 Due Sun 9/14
9	M	9/15	Intro to classification, Bayes classifier, KNN classifier	2.2.3	
10	W	9/17	Logistic Regression	4.1, 4.2, 4.3.1-3	
11	F	9/19	Multiple Logistic Regression / Multinomial Logistic Regression	4.3.4-5	HW #3 Due Sun 9/21
	M	9/22	***Project Day & Review***		
	W	9/24	**Midterm #1**		
12	F	9/26	Leave one out CV	5.1.1, 5.1.2	

Announcements:

- Homework #3 Due Sunday on Crowdmark
- Monday - Review day
  - Send your questions (survey)
- Wednesday - Exam #1
  - Bring 8.5x11 sheet of paper
  - Handwritten both sides
  - Anything you want on it, but must be your work
  - You will turn it in
  - Calculator w/o internet

Covered in this lecture

Last Time:

- Classification basics
- Bayes classifier
- KNN classifier

This time:

- Logistic Regression

Section 1

Review from last time

Error rate

- Training data:
  $\{(x_1, y_1), \cdots, (x_n, y_n)\}$ with y_i qualitative
- Estimate $\hat{y} = \hat{f}(x)$
- Indicator variable
  $\mathrm{I}(y_i \neq \hat{y}_i)$ *is 1 if not the same (misclassified) and 0 else*

Training error rate:

$$\frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=1}^{n} \mathrm{I}(y_i \neq \hat{y}_i)$$

Test error rate:

$$\mathrm{Ave}(\mathrm{I}(y_0 \neq \hat{y}_0))$$

Good classifier: one that minimizes test error rate, GET BETTER EXAMPLE FOR THIS

Best ever classifier

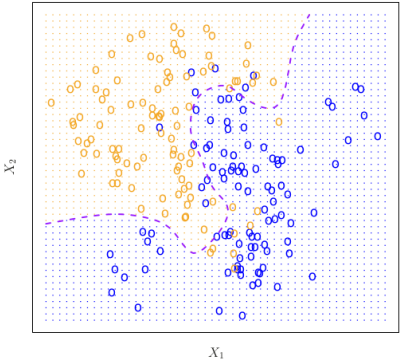
We can't have nice things

Bayes Classifier:
Give every observation the highest probability class given its predictor variables

$$\Pr(Y = j \mid X = x_0)$$

- It is possible to show (though the proof is outside of the scope of this book) that the test error rate is minimized, on average, by a very simple classifier that assigns each observation to the most likely class, given its

Bayes Decision Boundary



Bayes error rate

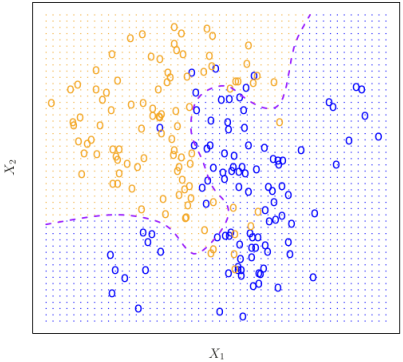
- Error at $X = x_0$

$$1 - \max_j \Pr(Y = j \mid X = x_0)$$

- Overall Bayes error:

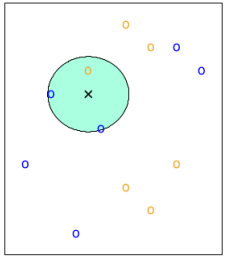
$$1 - E\left(\max_j \Pr(Y = j \mid X = x_0)\right)$$

This is the irreducible error

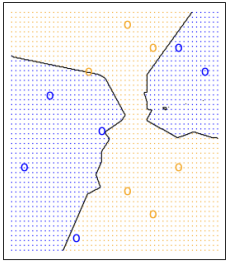


- Game: do as good a job as possible estimating the Bayes decision boundary
- Classify given observation with highest estimated probability

K-Nearest Neighbors



$K = 3$

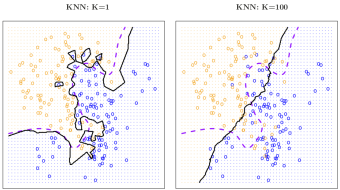


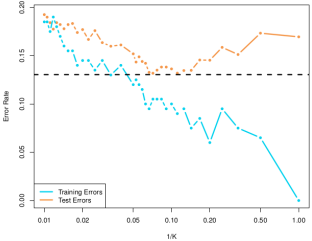
decision boundary

- Fix K positive integer
- $N(x)$ = the set of K closest neighbors to x
- Estimate conditional proability

$$\Pr(Y = j \mid X = x_0) = \frac{1}{K} \sum_{i \in N(x_0)} \mathrm{I}(y_i = j)$$

- Pick j with highest value

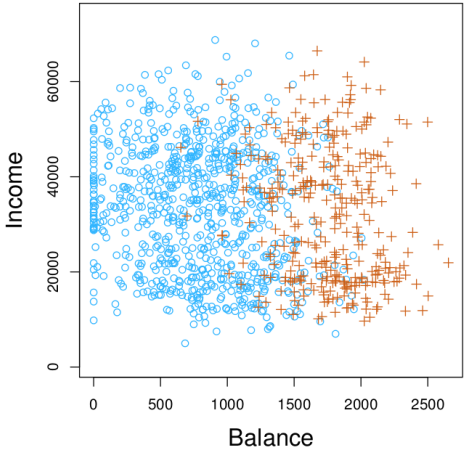


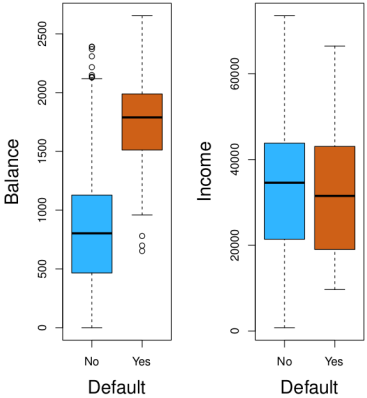


Section 2

Logistic Regression

Simulated `Default` data set



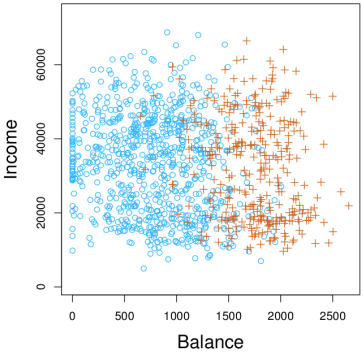


- 10,000 data points
- Individuals who defaulted shown in orange (reality is deafault rate is actualy 3% so only a fraction of those who didn't default are plotted)
- Goal: function $C(balance, income) = default/not$.

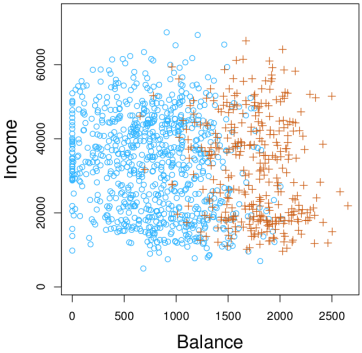
What is classification

- Classification: When the response variable is qualitative
- Goal: Model the probability that Y belongs to a particular category

$$p(\texttt{balance}) = \Pr(\texttt{default} = \texttt{yes} \mid \texttt{balance})$$



Goal for Balance data set



Goal: Model the probability that Y belongs to a particular category

Ex.

$\Pr(\texttt{default} = \texttt{yes} \mid \texttt{balance})$

- Use notation $p(\texttt{balance})$
- Choice of threshold depends on comfort with risk
- Note that highly contrived fake data means that largely decideable by balance, so we'll just look at that

Let's just use linear regression!

JK that's a bad idea

Bad idea:

- Set Y to be a dummy variable taking values in $\{1, 2, 3, \cdots\}$
- Run regression, and choose k based on what integer value $\hat{y}$ is closest to

Ex.

$$Y = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if stroke} \\ 2 & \text{if drug overdose} \\ 3 & \text{if epileptic seizure} \end{cases}$$

vs.

$$Y = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if mild} \\ 2 & \text{if moderate} \\ 3 & \text{if severe} \end{cases}$$

Ordering implies something about closeness, i.e., there has to be a monotonic relation between catergories.

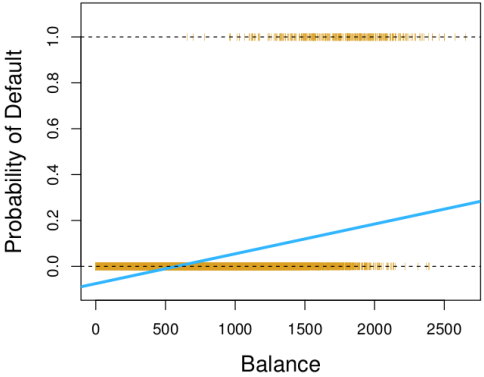
Draw a number line to emphasize this distinction.

Bad idea is still not a great idea for two levels

$$p(\texttt{balance}) = \Pr(\texttt{default} = \texttt{yes} \mid \texttt{balance})$$

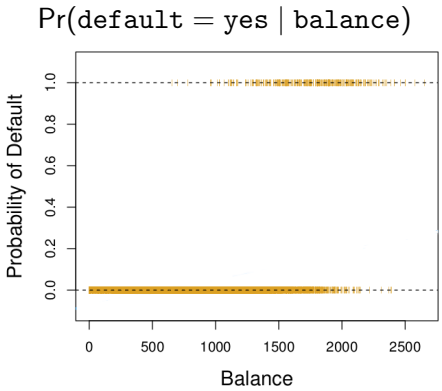
$$Y = \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if not default} \\ 1 & \text{if default} \end{cases}$$

- Fit linear regression
- Predict default if $\hat{y} > 0.5$; not default otherwise
- Could spit out values outside of [0,1]
- Can't interpret this as probability
- Regression methods can't accomdate qualitative response with more than two classes
- Doesn't provide meaningful estimates of $\Pr(Y \mid X)$ even with two classes



$$p(\texttt{balance}) = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \texttt{balance}$$

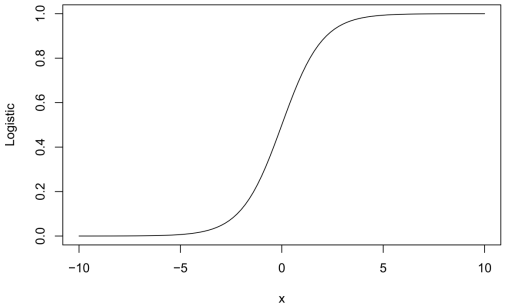
Approximating the probability



- Trying to approximate the probability with a function
- Draw some example functions
- Issues with linear, density on the bottom over-compenasates
- issues going outside of the [0,1] bound
- Better job: note 0, when balance below 1000, note 1 when balance over 2000, then simple add a soft curve connecting them.

Logistic function

$$y = \frac{e^x}{1 + e^x}$$



$$p(X) = \frac{e^{\beta_0 + \beta_1 X}}{1 + e^{\beta_0 + \beta_1 X}}$$

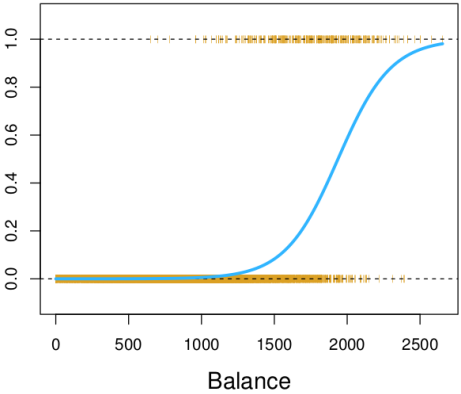
demonstrate the relation between equation and graph by moving the exp to the denom?

Try it out:
desmos.com/calculator/cw1pyzzqci

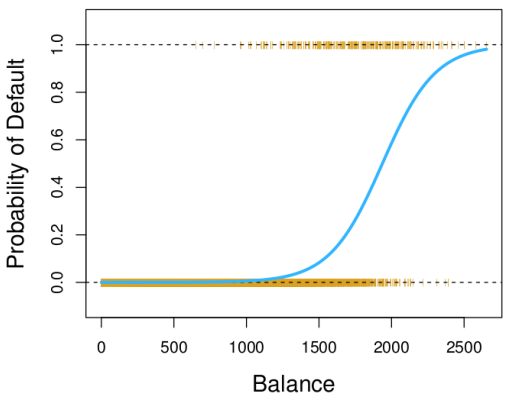
Logistic Regression

$$\Pr(\texttt{default} = \texttt{yes} \mid \texttt{balance}) = \frac{e^{\beta_0 + \beta_1 \texttt{balance}}}{1 + e^{\beta_0 + \beta_1 \texttt{balance}}}$$

beta0 and beta1 shift the curve left, right and change gain



What will the drawn logistic regression classifer predict for each of the following values of `Balance` *(you can choose decision boundary to be $p > 0.1$)*



Balance	Prediction
0	*No*
500	*No*
1000	*No*
1500	*Yes*
2000	*Yes*
2500	*Yes*

Odds

$$\frac{p(x)}{1-p(x)} = \frac{\Pr(Y=1 \mid X=x)}{1-\Pr(Y=1 \mid X=x)} = \frac{\Pr(Y=1 \mid X=x)}{\Pr(Y=0 \mid X=x)}$$

Probability or risk $= \frac{p}{p+q}$

Odds $= p : q$

- Logistic function is chosen so that log odds are linear
- Can take any value from 0 (low odds) to ∞ (high odds)

Examples:

- If the probability of default is 90% what are the odds?
  - $p(x) = 0.9$
  - $\frac{0.9}{1-0.9} = 9$
- If the odds are $1/3$, what is the probability of default?
  - $\frac{p}{1-p} = 1/3$
  - $3p = 1 - p$
  - $4p = 1$
  - $p = 1/4$

Making the nonlinear linear

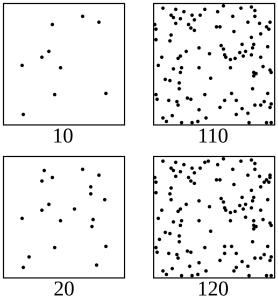
Assume the (natural) log odds (logits) follow a linear model

$$\log\left(\frac{p(x)}{1-p(x)}\right) = \beta_0 + \beta_1 x$$

Do some algebra and get $p(x)$:

$$p(x) = \frac{e^{\beta_0+\beta_1 x}}{1+e^{\beta_0+\beta_1 x}}$$

- refer to Weber's law in psychophysics: perception works by times not by additions
- or in gambling, one doubles down.



(wiki image link)

Playing with the logistic function: desmos.com/calculator/cw1pyzzqci

Using coefficients to make predictions

	Coefficient	Std. error	z-statistic	p-value
`Intercept`	−10.6513	0.3612	−29.5	<0.0001
`balance`	0.0055	0.0002	24.9	<0.0001

What is the estimated probability of default for someone with a balance of $1,000?

$$\hat{p}(X) = \frac{e^{\hat{\beta}_0+\hat{\beta}_1 X}}{1+e^{\hat{\beta}_0+\hat{\beta}_1 X}} = \frac{e^{-10.6513+0.0055\times 1000}}{1+e^{-10.6513+0.0055\times 1000}} = 0.006$$

What is the estimated probability of default for someone with a balance of $2,000:

$$\hat{p}(X) = \frac{e^{\hat{\beta}_0+\hat{\beta}_1 X}}{1+e^{\hat{\beta}_0+\hat{\beta}_1 X}} = \frac{e^{-10.6513+0.0055\times 2000}}{1+e^{-10.6513+0.0055\times 2000}} = 0.586$$

Interpreting the coefficients

$$p(x) = \frac{e^{\beta_0+\beta_1 x}}{1+e^{\beta_0+\beta_1 x}}$$

$$\log\left(\frac{p(x)}{1-p(x)}\right) = \beta_0 + \beta_1 x$$

	Coefficient	Std. error	z-statistic	p-value
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`balance`	0.0055	0.0002	24.9	<0.0001

- β_1 means increasing x by one unit increases the log odds by β_1 unit
- In this case, increasing the balance by 1 means increasing the log odds of default by 0.0055

Confusion Matrix: Predicting `default` from `balance`

		True default status		
		No	Yes	Total
Predicted default status	No	9644	252	9896
	Yes	23	81	104
	Total	9667	333	10000

- Overall error $(c+b)/N = 2.75\%$
- This table is from the LDA section, but we can use this for understanding confusion matrix

		True		
		Yes	No	Total
Predicted	Yes	a	b	$a+b$
	No	c	d	$c+d$
	Total	$a+c$	$b+d$	N

Test your understanding: PollEv

Do coding in jupyter notebook

Next time

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